[LIT-POEM-012] Yarnao Khamayon

Translation: Fellowship of the Terrace Labor Guild

Work Type: POEM | Creator: S. Kanrei | Year: 2004
Village: Somdal | Dialect: Standard Tangkhul | Book ID: None
Publisher / Source: Tangkhul Writers Forum, Ukhrul
Clearance: Author Permitted | Permission: community_authorized | Status: verified

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Themes: Youth agricultural cooperatives and reciprocal labor exchange (*Yarnao*), Communal dignity of agrarian labor on steep mountain terraces

Structure & Meter: Agrarian work-rhythm verse in trochaic meters mirroring the downward s

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Critical Overview: Composed by S. Kanrei of Somdal, this poem commemorates the Yarnao labor group, a central institution of traditional Tangkhul youth

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Indigenous Tangkhul Literary Text / Stanzas:

Yarnao mayarnao kaphung lung-ngakui eina luireili tonkashun, shingkapha
Luirim chonkashan mayarnao eina shanaonao, akhan akhang eina kharor tont
Kachamnao changvei eina phanung zatta-laga, lui-ngatha kharorli lasakakh
’Mayarnao khamayon, i-ramwui kaphung mathali lui-kashak yarshon-sakashun
Ngaleili meingap-pamkakhung mayarnao ningung-laga, phanung khon eina nga
Yarnaonao leikashan eina ngachomkaphang mirin, Tangkhul thotharanli mash

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English Translation & Literary Rendering:

At sunrise the youth labor fellowship (Yarnao) descends from high villag
Clad in sturdy working cloaks, young men and maidens work shoulder to sh
Hoes striking the wet mountain soil in unison, their voices blend in rhy
’Comrades of the labor guild, let us carve fruitful terraces upon these
Sweat glistening on youthful brows, they transform stony cliffs into rip
Through mutual labor and generous fellowship, the Yarnao guild preserves

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Key Poetic & Literary Vocabulary Terms:

* Yarnao : Youth labor fellowship / mutual-aid cooperative gr
* Lui-ngatha : Terrace cultivation / tilling the steep mountain p
* Phanung : Traditional wooden and iron hoe used for cutting t

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